

Category Policy Addendum: Home & Kitchen

KARTWAY CUSTOMER OPERATIONS POLICY HANDBOOK ##

SECTION 14.4: CATEGORY ADDENDUM — HOME & KITCHEN

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Customer Experience

14.4.1 Return Windows The standard Kartway 30-day return policy is modified for specific sub-categories within the Home & Kitchen department to account for hygiene, depreciation, and seasonal usage.

- * 14.4.1.1 Small Kitchen Appliances (SKAs): Any item containing an integrated motorized drive or heating element (including but not limited to blenders, air fryers, espresso machines, and food processors) must be returned within 14 calendar days of the confirmed delivery date. Returns initiated on Day 15 or later must be systematically rejected by the customer support agent.
- * 14.4.1.2 Major Domestic Appliances (MDAs): Large units (including refrigerators, range hoods, and built-in ovens) are eligible for return within 45 calendar days of delivery.
- * 14.4.1.3 Seasonal & Outdoor Kitchen Items: Patio dining sets, freestanding pizza ovens, and barbecue grills are subject to the standard 30-day window, provided they have not been fueled or fired.

14.4.2 Condition and Original Packaging Requirements Agents must verify the physical state of the returned merchandise before authorizing shipping labels or refund releases.

* 14.4.2.1 Food-Contact Surfaces: Any item designed to come into direct contact with food or beverages (such as cookware, dinnerware, and cutting boards) must be returned unused. If the warehouse inspection reveals organic residue, grease, or water marks, the return will be denied, and the item will be shipped back to the customer at their own expense.

* 14.4.2.2 Original Packaging Mandate: For all "Cookware & Bakeware" and "Small Kitchen Appliances" sub-categories, original packaging—including custom-molded styrofoam, cardboard inserts, and plastic protective sleeves—is mandatory.

* 14.4.2.3 Restocking Fees: If a return is accepted but is missing the original branded outer box or the internal molded packaging inserts, a flat 18% restocking fee is deducted from the customer's total refund amount. This fee is non-negotiable and cannot be waived by Tier 1 support agents.

14.4.3 Hazardous and Perishable Handling Rules Specific safety and logistical protocols must be followed for items containing chemicals, pressurized systems, or food products.

* 14.4.3.1 Perishable Gourmet Foodstuffs: Coffee beans, spices, syrups, and other consumable kitchen liquids are non-returnable. If a customer reports transit damage, contamination, or premature expiration, agents are authorized to issue a full refund without requiring a return, provided the claim is logged within 3 calendar days of delivery and is accompanied by photographic proof of the defect.

* 14.4.3.2 Compressor-Bearing Appliances: Wine coolers, portable ice makers, and mini-fridges contain chemical refrigerants. Due to oil displacement during transit, these units must sit upright and undisturbed for a mandatory 24-hour settling period upon arrival at the Kartway return center before warehouse personnel can plug them in for testing. Consequently, agents must never issue "Refund on Scan" (ROS) for these items; refunds may only be released 48 hours after the warehouse receives the unit.

* 14.4.3.3 Bladed Cutlery: Kitchen knives, mandolins, and food processor replacement blades must be returned using the original protective plastic blade guards. If the guard is missing, the customer must wrap the blade in at least 3 layers of heavy-duty bubble wrap before sealing the shipping carton. Failure to do so voids the return transit insurance and places liability for carrier injury on the sender.

14.4.4 Warranty and Repair Provisions Warranty claims within the Home & Kitchen category are administered directly by Kartway's specialized claims team rather than third-party manufacturers, subject to the following durations:

* 14.4.4.1 Motorized and Heated Appliances: All small appliances covered under clause 14.4.1.1 carry a 180-day limited warranty from the date of purchase. This warranty covers mechanical failures, electrical short-circuits, and heating element degradation. It explicitly excludes cosmetic discoloration, scratch damage to non-stick coatings, and damage resulting from commercial use.

* 14.4.4.2 Non-Motorized Cookware: Cast iron, stainless steel, and ceramic cookware items carry a 365-day structural warranty covering warping, handle rivet failure, and enamel cracking under normal residential thermal conditions.

* 14.4.4.3 Resolution Paths: For valid warranty claims inside the warranty window, agents must offer the following remedies in this specific order of priority:

1. *Repair:* Shipment of a replacement component (e.g., a detachable power cord or lid) if user-replaceable.
2. *Replacement:* Shipment of an identical refurbished or new unit.
3. *Store Credit:* A Kartway digital gift card equivalent to the original purchase price if the item is permanently out of stock. Cash refunds are not authorized for warranty claims settled after the initial return window has closed.